

Question 55 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Evaluate the usefulness of the Kirkpatrick model for judging the effectiveness of an organisational training program.

Answer

The model is useful as a comprehensive framework, with known limitations that HRD professionals should manage.

- 1. Usefulness – completeness:** Forces attention beyond smile sheets to learning, behaviour and results.
- 2. Usefulness – communication:** Four levels are easy to explain to managers and trainees.
- 3. Usefulness – design aid:** Encourages setting measures during TNA and design.
- 4. Usefulness – diagnosis:** If reaction is high but behaviour low, look at transfer climate, not only the trainer.
- 5. Limitation – causality:** Level 4 results have many causes; training may be only one.
- 6. Limitation – cost and time:** Behaviour and results evaluation is harder; firms may stop at level 1.
- 7. Limitation – not all programmes need full 4 levels:** Short awareness talks vs critical safety training differ.
- 8. Evaluative conclusion:** Highly useful as a guiding model if applied proportionately and supplemented with transfer and ROI thinking; not a mechanical proof of training success.

***Conclusion.** Overall, Kirkpatrick remains a valuable HRD tool for judging effectiveness when used thoughtfully rather than as a paperwork ritual.*